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Element.getAttribute()

The **getAttribute()** method of the [Element](#) interface returns the value of a specified attribute on the element.

If the given attribute does not exist, the value returned will either be `null` or `""` (the empty string); see [Non-existing attributes](#) for details.

Syntax

```
getAttribute(attributeName)
```

Parameters

- `attributeName` is the name of the attribute whose value you want to get.

Return value

A string containing the value of `attributeName`.

Examples

```
<!-- example div in an HTML DOC -->
```

```
<div id="div1">Hi Champ!</div>
```

```
// in a console
```

```
const div1 = document.getElementById('div1');
```

```
//=> <div id="div1">Hi Champ!</div>
```

```
const exampleAttr= div1.getAttribute('id');
```

```
//=> "div1"
```

```
const align = div1.getAttribute('align')
```

```
//=> null
```

Description

Lower casing

When called on an HTML element in a DOM flagged as an HTML document, `getAttribute()` lower-cases its argument before proceeding.

Non-existing attributes

Essentially all web browsers (Firefox, Internet Explorer, recent versions of Opera, Safari, Konqueror, and iCab, as a non-exhaustive list) return `null` when the specified attribute does not exist on the specified element; this is what [the current DOM specification draft](#) specifies. The old DOM 3 Core specification, on the other hand, says that the correct return value in this case is actually the *empty string*, and some DOM implementations implement this behavior. The implementation of `getAttribute()` in XUL (Gecko) actually follows the DOM 3 Core specification and returns an empty string. Consequently, you should use [element.hasAttribute\(\)](#) to check for an

attribute's existence prior to calling `getAttribute()` if it is possible that the requested attribute does not exist on the specified element.

Retrieving nonce values

For security reasons, [CSP](#) nonces from non-script sources, such as CSS selectors, and `.getAttribute("nonce")` calls are hidden.

```
let nonce = script.getAttribute('nonce');
// returns empty string
```

Instead of retrieving the nonce from the content attribute, use the [nonce](#) property:

```
let nonce = script.nonce;
```

Specifications

Specification
DOM Standard # ref-for-dom-element-getattribute ^①

Browser compatibility

[Report problems with this compatibility data on GitHub](#)

	Chrome	Edge	Firefox	Opera	Safari	Chrome Android	Firefox for Android	Opera Android	
getAttribute	Chrome 1	Edge 12	Firefox 1	Opera 8	Safari 1	Chrome 18 Android	Firefox 4 for Android	Opera 10.1 Android	

Tip: you can click/tap on a cell for more information.

Full support

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